Growing Acceptance

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Schitt's Creek was a show that really opened my eyes to the way the LGBTQ community should be perceived. In India, we have made slow progress towards accepting the community. In the name of acceptance, the lives and struggles of those who identify as 'queer' are mocked as entertainment. As we shifted online during the pandemic, it became easy for people to open up about their struggles. Articles and videos, even things like putting one's preferred pronoun on public platforms, helped create safe spaces. There have been shows that have tried to eradicate the idea of homophobia. This is the kind of future I hope for—where we completely eradicate homophobia and queerphobia. While this is still a utopian dream, which would require years of learning and unlearning, we can start by being aware of and sensitive to the community and by providing platforms to queer people across all fields. ■





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BUILDING OUR TOMORROW

We need a country where we address topics like sexuality or the issues of marginalised communities with sensitivity; where the issues of caste biases will be addressed with care because everyone will be friends who fight, argue but connect. We need to bargain and negotiate and not reduce anything to a binary. A nuanced country adapting to the contemporary times and borrowing from history will indeed shape India into a sustainable nation. ■